Scars Heal

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F, Gen

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Additional Tags:
Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Angst with a Happy Ending, Light Angst, Scars, Catra Needs a Hug (She-Ra), Adora Needs a Hug (She-Ra), Hurt Adora (She-Ra), Post-Canon, Flashbacks, Missing Scene, Catra & Glimmer Friendship (She-Ra), Glimmer is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Mentioned Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

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by Mimmers

Summary

On the night before their wedding, Catra starts spiraling after seeing the scars she left on Adora's back during the Battle of Bright Moon and thinking about how much she has hurt her. To help assure Catra that Adora doesn't mind the scars and that her love for Catra is unconditional, Glimmer tells her what happened in the immediate aftermath of the Battle of Bright Moon.

It was a beautiful night on Etheria.

Catra was sitting on a railing in the balcony of Bright Moon's guest room, where Shadow Weaver's garden used to be years ago. She was gazing into the distance, taking in everything she could see.

The view was beautiful from up high. That's why she always liked to climb to the top of the Fright Zone back in the Horde. The sights, the air… It helped Catra get her thoughts in order.

In her right hand, she was fiddling with something with her fingers. The golden buckle in the shape of a wing that she had gotten from Adora.

When they got engaged.

Catra clutched the buckle and sighed. Her brain was overwhelming her so many mixed thoughts.

Anticipation. Anxiety. Love. Fear. Happiness. Regret.

Catra had never been so excited about something, while simultaneously being so afraid at the same time.

Could she go through with this?

"Catra."

Catra heard a familiar, sparkling sound behind her, and saw a flash of pink in her peripheral vision.

"Hey, Sparkles." Catra said quietly, without bothering to turn around or even look behind. Her gaze was locked to nothing in particular, just staring off into the distance.

"What are you doing here?" Glimmer's voice asked. Catra could hear Glimmer tapping her foot on the ground. "It's two in the morning, Catra. The wedding's *today*."

"Couldn't sleep." Catra replied. She still wasn't looking at Glimmer. "Anxiety. Figured getting some fresh air might help."

"Has it?"

"Nope."

Catra heard the sound of footsteps coming from behind her, then saw Glimmer leaning on the railing right next to her. Catra shifted her gaze to the sky, where Glimmer was now looking too.

“The stars are so beautiful.” Catra said.

“Yeah.” Glimmer nodded. “I may not be the biggest fan of space, but…”

“How did you know to come find me?” Catra wondered.

“Melog.” Glimmer explained. “It came scratching and mewling behind my door to wake me up. That’s when I knew you were up to something stupid again.”

“Figures.” Catra muttered. “It’s so clingy. Always crying when I’m not around.”

“Or maybe, it figured you needed someone to talk to.” Glimmer smiled, then asked: “Catra, what is this about?”

“What is *what* about?” Catra deflected, trying to avoid the question.

“It’s your big day tomorrow!” Glimmer said. “And Adora’s big day, too! She’s gonna be really cross with you if you sleep in. Is sleeping in different beds for tonight getting to you or something?”

“No, it’s not that.” Catra shook her head.

“Then what, you getting cold feet or something?” Glimmer snarked. When Catra remained silent, she gasped and started getting heated: “ *No*. You are *not* serious right now.”

“I-” Catra started, but was cut off by Glimmer suddenly grabbing her collar and forcing Catra to look at her.

“You are **NOT** doing this to Adora!” The fury in Glimmer’s eyes was something Catra had not seen since the two of them had battled inside the Horde base in the Whispering Woods all those years ago. “Everyone has been planning this day for months, Adora has waited for this all of her life! Do you have the slightest idea how *devastated* Adora will be if you don’t show up? I swear, I’ll come find you and drag you to the ceremony *by your tail* if you try to run now!”

“Calm down, I’m not running!” Catra yelled, causing Glimmer to let go of her.

“Then what *are* you doing?” Glimmer asked, while Catra was fixing her collar.

“I…” Catra sighed. “I just, I don’t know if I can go through with this. Or if this was a good idea to begin with.”

" *Catra* -" Glimmer's voice was so exasperated. She took a deep breath to calm down, then continued: "What do you mean, exactly?"

"Everything." Catra started. "Everything that's happened between us. I don't know if Adora deserves **this**, to be *shackled* to me for the rest of her life, after everything I've done to her."

"Catra, *she loves you*." Glimmer claimed. "She *wants* this, she wants *you*."

"I know." Catra held her own head. "And I don't know if I'm *worthy* of her love. Adora deserves so much better. She's *She-Ra*, she could have literally anyone. Someone who won't harm her, someone who *hasn't* already harmed her. *The way I have."*

"Not this again." Glimmer groaned, having been through this very conversation so many times. "Catra, you've made so much progress! You've put a ton of effort into bettering yourself, you've done your best to make amends with everyone including Adora herself, all your sessions with Perfuma… You're basically unrecognizable from the person you were when you did all those things."

"But I still *did them*, Sparkles." Catra countered. "And I'm not talking about just my actions here, I meant how I've *physically* hurt Adora too."

Glimmer gently placed her hand on Catra's shoulder and asked once more: "What do you mean?"

"I…" Catra hesitated for a second, but decided being completely honest was important. "Yesterday, Adora was trying on her dress one more time, to be *absolutely* sure that it fits her. You know how she is, she wants everything to be perfect."

"Yeah, I know." Glimmer said.

"When she undressed," Catra continued. "I caught a glimpse of her back. And on her back…" Catra was now staring at her hands. "There were these scars. And I immediately remembered, *I did that to her*."

"The Battle of Bright Moon." Glimmer realized.

"I-I didn't even think that wounds left on She-Ra would've carried over to Adora's body." Catra stammered, clenching her fists. "But it made the reality set in for me, just how much I've scarred Adora. Both mentally *and physically."*

"Catra…" Glimmer whispered.

Catra heard Shadow Weaver's voice echoing inside of her head, back from when they were in Mystacor making their way towards the Failsafe when she had said to Adora:

"Haven't you two hurt each other enough?"

"I'm so scared." Catra's voice cracked. "That I'm eventually gonna just slide back into my old habits, that I'll somehow end up hurting Adora again and that she… She finally sees that I'm a lost cause and gives up on me, for good."

"That won't happen." Glimmer tried to reassure Catra. "Catra, Adora loves you completely unconditionally, in a way I've never seen someone love before. She doesn't hold **any** of what you've done against you, certainly not *now*. And," She smiled. "I know for a fact she doesn't mind the scars on her back."

"How do you know?" Catra wondered.

"I uh," Glimmer scratched the back of her head. "Did Adora ever tell you what happened *after* the battle of Bright Moon?"

"No, we… Haven't talked too much about the war since we took down Prime." Catra replied.

"I guess it's about time someone told you." Glimmer said. "Just so you'll see how devoted Adora has been to you, from the very beginning. See, after you guys retreated from Bright Moon…"

While recounting the events to Catra, Glimmer's mind also flashed back years ago, to what had happened back then.

After the Battle of Bright Moon.

"*Thank you*."

Adora had done it.

The Horde had retreated. Bright Moon was safe. The princesses were united.

The Rebellion had won the Battle of Bright Moon. Adora, Bow, Glimmer, Angella, the other princesses and Sea Hawk were busy celebrating their victory.

"And thank you, to all of you." Angella added, looking at the princesses. "We could've never done this without your help."

“Oh you know, it was like, no big deal or whatever.” Mermista said, blushing slightly before asking: “So umm, what now?”

“The Whispering Woods took a lot of damage.” Perfuma said sadly. “We’ll need to find a way to help it recover.”

“And large chunks of it are still frozen.” Frosta added.

“Which means the Horde could be back at any moment.” Adora concluded, looking towards the direction where the Horde had gone.

Where *Catra* had gone.

“I don’t think they’ll be back anytime soon.” Glimmer said. “This was such a crushing defeat for them, they’ll be licking their wounds for a while! It’ll give us some time to breathe.”

“Maybe. Still wouldn’t hurt to be on our guard.” Bow replied, arms crossed.

“Right now, what we need is some rest.” Glimmer stated. “How about we take things easy for now, you guys make sure your own kingdoms are safe and we can gather back here in a week, see what we can do about the forest and also ward off any potential Horde attacks!”

“Sure, that sounds good I guess.” Mermista shrugged.

“Ah, yes!” Sea Hawk exclaimed. “We shall be back for another exciting Rebellion *ADVENTURE!”*

“Ummm, not *you*.” Mermista poked Sea Hawk’s chest with her index finger. “You’d just try to set the woods on fire or something.”

“Oh, I would never do that, my dearest Mermista!” Sea Hawk stated, then looked at the forest and pondered: “Hmmm, but it *would* help thaw it…”

“Yeah, no.” Mermista grabbed Sea Hawk by his ear. “Let’s go with the original plan. I’m gonna make sure *this one* stays home, so we’ll still *have* a forest to save.”

“Let’s do it! Oh, this will be so exciting!” Perfuma yelled.

“See you in a week!” Frosta said, waving at the others.

“Bye guys! Seeya, and thanks again for the help!” Adora, Bow and Glimmer waved at the others. The other princesses and Sea Hawk then departed, leaving just the three of them and Angella standing there on the battlefield.

“We did it.” Adora said, content. “We actually *did it.* ”

“How are you feeling, Adora?” Glimmer asked her. “You look a little pale.”

“You know, all things considered I feel pretty-” Adora started, then suddenly lost her footing and fell to the ground.

“ *Adora!*” Bow and Glimmer hurried around Adora to help her back up.

“What’s wrong with her?” Angella asked, concerned.

“I-I’m fine, I’m fine!” Adora tried reassuring the others. “Just feeling a little dizzy, that’s all.”

“You’re *exhausted*.” Bow stated. “No wonder, you took the brunt of the damage in this battle.”

“I’ll be fine, I’ll just walk it off. I need to-” Adora attempted getting back up on her feet, but nearly collapsed again. Bow and Glimmer caught her before she would fall.

"What you *need* right now is a shower and some good sleep." Glimmer said, then turned to her mom: "Bow and I will take Adora to her room, we'll make sure she actually *gets* some rest."

"Alright. Please have a swift recovery, Adora." Angella said, her voice full of warmth. "And please do try to rest, you've earned it after all that you've done today."

"Thank you, I-I'll try." Adora mumbled.

Glimmer teleported herself, Adora and Bow to Adora's room.

"You guys, I promise I'm fine." Adora told her friends. "You really don't need to-"

"None of that!" Glimmer shushed Adora by pressing her index finger over her lips. "This is just another one of those messed up things that the Horde has instilled in you.

"It's not wrong or weakness to show signs of physical exhaustion, Adora." Bow said gently, helping Adora to her bed. "*Everyone* needs to rest sometimes. I'm sure even Hordak takes days off to relax!"

"Somehow I doubt that." Adora replied, then gratefully continued: "But, thank you. I appreciate you two being here, I- Ah!" Adora winced as soon as she laid down on her back.

“Are you hurt?” Glimmer worried.

“It’s no biggie.” Adora sharply inhaled through her teeth and sat up clutching her back. “I uh, I bashed my back against a rock pretty well to get Catra off me.”

“*Ouch*.” Bow grimaced. “That sounds painful!”

“Eh, it wasn’t so bad.” Adora waved her hand. “I mean, I’m *She-Ra*. You should’ve seen what *Catra* looked like!”

“Wait, I didn’t know injuries you sustained as She-Ra carried over to *your* body.” Glimmer realized.

“Me neither.” Adora shrugged, then rubbed her cheek. “And looks like not *all* of them did, Catra scratched my cheek when I was She-Ra but it seems to be completely fine now.”

“We should probably take a look at your back anyway.” Bow said. “In case you need medical attention.”

“It’s alright, I’ll just sleep laying on my stomach and-” Adora started.

"Adora, take your jacket off. *Now*." Glimmer commanded.

"Ugh, fine." Adora conceded, removing her jacket and handing it over to Bow. "I don't see what the big deal is, I mean it doesn't even hurt that much." She then turned around, facing her back towards Glimmer.

"Wait…" Bow saw some red stains through the back of Adora's white shirt. "Is that *blood?"*

"Adora, shirt off!" Glimmer said. Adora hesitated for a second, then complied and lifted her shirt.

"How does it look?" Adora asked.

Bow and Glimmer were ***horrified*** by what they saw; There were ten deep claw marks running down Adora's upper back, five on each side.

In the exact same places that Catra had clawed She-Ra.

"What the *fu*-!" Glimmer gasped, covering her mouth with her hands out of shock.

"D-did *Catra* do this to you?" Bow asked, completely stunned.

“Wait, how bad is it?” Adora tossed her shirt on the floor, then hurried towards the mirror in her room, turned around and tried her best to get a good look of her back, eventually managing to see the scars: “*O-oh*. Oh, ***wow***.”

“That’s so messed up!” Glimmer yelled. “I knew Catra was *bad*, but this is just on a whole another level!”

“How could she do something like this?” Bow shook his head. “To *her ex-best friend,* no less!”

“I…” Adora mumbled. The events of the past few days had taken a massive toll on her mentally, and it was finally all catching up to her. While Bow and Glimmer were still chastising Catra’s actions, Adora fell on her knees and broke down crying.

“Adora!” Glimmer rushed to where Adora was, and hugged her tight. While Adora was crying against her shoulder, Glimmer gently whispered to her: “Hey, hey it’s going to be okay. Scars heal.”

“Exactly. We’re here, Adora.” Bow also hugged Adora. “You’re our friend, and we promise we’re going to make sure you’ll be alright.”

Bow and Glimmer held Adora and each other in a gentle embrace, letting Adora get all of her tears out.

“C-Catra…” Adora sobbed. “S-she.. She *hates me*.”

“Eh?” Bow and Glimmer gave one another confused looks. Then, after they let go of Adora Bow asked her: “What do you mean?”

“I…” Adora sniffled. “W-When Catra and I were stuck in that First Ones ruin, it started showing us… Memories. It like, scanned our brains somehow and started feeding us visions from our past, growing up in the Horde. And it showed us something that I had completely forgotten, until now.”

“What was it?” Glimmer asked her.

"We, we were little.” Adora continued, wiping the last few tears from her eyes. “A-and we saw that the door to the Black Garnet Chamber was left open. Shadow Weaver never let us enter there as kids, so naturally we were curious.”

“You went in?” Bow guessed. Adora nodded.

“Then soon after, Shadow Weaver came in after us. She seemed… Weakened by something.” Adora said. “We managed to hide from her for a while, and we saw that she took her mask off. That was the first time I had ever seen her face, she looked *scary*. Her eyes…”

Adora got quiet for a moment. Glimmer gently pat her shoulder so she would continue.

"That's when she spotted us." Adora kept going. "We tried to run, but Catra was frozen by Shadow Weaver's magic. Shadow Weaver, she…" Adora swallowed, trying to figure out how to put this next part into words. "She basically threatened Catra, saying that the only reason she kept Catra around was because she was my friend, and that if anything ever happened to me she would *k-kill her*."

"Seriously?" Glimmer whispered, shocked. "*Man*. I knew she was a total witch, but that is just… *Wow*."

"I'm starting to understand why Catra acts the way she does." Bow said, for the first time feeling sympathy towards Catra. "But that still doesn't give her the right to take it out on you, or hurt you this way!"

Despite Bow's words, Adora looked pensive and really ashamed of herself.

"Catra and I, we had made this promise." Adora said quietly. "'You look out for me, and I look out for you.' But I failed her. I was never able to protect her from the way Shadow Weaver treated her. I could've done so much more, I *should've* done more!"

“There was nothing you could’ve done, Adora.” Glimmer tried reassuring her friend. “You were a child, Shadow Weaver had power over you too.”

“I could’ve stood up for Catra more.” Adora muttered. “Taken her side. I could’ve told Shadow Weaver to stop, she might’ve listened to me-”

“She would’ve just used that as an excuse to get rid of Catra.” Bow suggested. “You did everything you could, Adora. I’m sure deep down Catra knows that too.”

“That’s not all.” Adora sighed. “After we saw that memory, I realized that when I left the Horde, I…” She began tearing up again. “I basically *left Catra to die*. No wonder she’s so angry at me, what kind of friend does that to someone?”

“Adora-”

“I don’t regret leaving the Horde.” Adora clarified. “They’re evil, and they’re actively destroying Etheria. It was the right thing to do. But, I never wanted to leave *Catra*. And yet, I did. I abandoned her, left her alone at Shadow Weaver’s mercy.”

“That’s not fair, Adora.” Bow shook his head. “You didn’t *abandon* her. Catra could’ve come with you, she could’ve left the Horde too!”

"That's what I tried telling her." Adora closed her eyes. "But instead she cut all ties with me, *literally*. I ruined our friendship, I've lost her. *For good*."

"So that's really what this is about?" Glimmer scratched her head. "You're not upset about the scars she gave you?"

"What?" Adora was confused. "No, why would I be? Wait, is that what you-"

"But we thought-" Bow started.

"It was *a battle*." Adora stated, as if it was self-explanatory to her. "Scars are an integral part of battles, it's only natural I'd end up with a few cuts!"

"But they look *so nasty…"* Glimmer said quietly.

"Oh pfft, this is *nothing*." Adora waved her hand dismissively. "I've gotten scuffed up *way* worse in the past, Catra as well. Heck, I remember one time during training I accidentally busted open Catra's left cheek and the scar didn't fully heal for like an entire year! So if anything, now we're even."

Adora managed to laugh a little. Bow and Glimmer looked at each other, completely taken back by Adora's reaction.

"I, guess that makes sense?" Bow shrugged. "So weird…"

"It's just like Glimmer said. Scars heal." Adora claimed, then got sad again. "But, our friendship… It's broken beyond repair."

"Hey, don't be like that." Glimmer tried cheering Adora up. "You might be able to patch things up with Catra some day!"

"Yeah!" Bow agreed. "Catra has done some- Okay, a LOT of bad things. But she's not *evil*. I'm sure one day she'll realize what she's done, that you were right and is willing to make amends."

"You think?" Adora asked hopefully. Bow nodded.

"It might take a while," Bow continued. "It might be a *looong* while before you get there. But eventually, you two are going to become friends again, it'll just take time!"

"Bow's right." Glimmer said. "You and Catra will figure things out."

"Thanks, you guys." Adora said, full of gratitude. "I-I really don't know what I would do without you two."

“You’d be a completely lost cause.” Glimmer joked, and all three of them laughed. Then, she added: “Hey, mom’s got some ointment for cuts that I could borrow. It’d probably help your wounds heal up faster!”

“Oh, I uh,” Adora looked slightly embarrassed. “This is a bit weird, but I… Kinda want them to stay.”

“Huh?” Bow crossed his arms and tilted his head with a puzzled expression on his face.

“Okay, I know this sounds so strange, but I think they look kinda *cool?”* Adora explained. “Like I said, scars are a part of battle, the ones on my back serve as a sign of *victory*. That despite the odds, we won against the Horde. They’ll be a reminder that I managed to defeat Catra this time, that I’ll never stop fighting for what I think is right and…” Adora got more wistful. “They’re the last thing I have left of her now.”

“You are *so weird* sometimes, Adora.” Glimmer smiled. “But on some level, I think I get you on this one.”

“Yeah, it’s unusual but… I get it, too.” Bow agreed, before adding: “You should still clean up those wounds a little, just so they don’t get infected.”

“Good idea.” Adora nodded. “I’m gonna hop in the shower real quick.”

“Good. We’ll be waiting for you here, we’re gonna make sure you’ll actually *rest*.” Glimmer said playfully. Adora smiled, then headed towards the bathroom.

“She seems to be feeling better.” Bow said to Glimmer after Adora had left. “I’m glad she’s not letting the scars get to her, I know if someone did something like that to me I would be-”

“Bow, I think Adora isn’t telling us everything.” Glimmer stated.

“Huh? What do you mean?” Bow asked her.

“The way she talks about Catra.” Glimmer explained. “How much all of this is affecting her. I see it on her face. I don’t think it’s just Adora losing her best friend, I think there might be more to this. *More than she’s letting on.”*

“Whaaat?” Bow gasped. “You don’t mean Adora has *feelings?* For *her?*”

“I’m not sure,” Glimmer replied. “But it would explain *a lot.”*

“Do you think Catra knows? Or feels the same way?”

“If she did, she probably would’ve come with Adora instead of staying at the Horde.”

“Good point. So,” Bow crossed his arms, thinking. “What do we do now?”

“We have to look out for Adora.” Glimmer said, clenching her right fist. “We have to keep her safe, make sure Catra can’t hurt her again.”

Bow agreed. Soon, Adora came back from the shower, feeling more refreshed. Bow and Glimmer stayed by her side, making sure she would get some sleep.

She was going to need to stay well-rested, for future battles against the Horde.

“...Adora never cared about the scars.” Glimmer finished telling the story to Catra. “Heck, once she learned how to heal as She-Ra she could’ve gotten rid of them *at any point she wanted.* But she didn’t, she wanted to keep them as a symbol of her resolve and as a reminder of *you*, because she thought she had nothing else left of you. The only things on her mind at that time was that you

hated her, the fear that she had lost you forever and how she felt *she* had betrayed *you* by leaving the Horde. She was blaming *herself* for what happened between you two."

"She, she shouldn't have!" Catra muttered, feeling shame and regret. "Adora did the right thing when she left, she… *She was right.* All along. I'm the one who betrayed her, *I'm* the one who ruined everything! Everything that happened, *it's my fault."*

"And you should tell *her* that."

Catra and Glimmer sat there in silence for a while. Then, suddenly, Catra chuckled.

"I remember." She said fondly.

"Remember what?" Glimmer wondered.

"That time Adora cut my cheek open." Catra smiled, rubbing her left cheek. "We were training with these polearm things, and Adora got a little too carried away and slipped and… Haha," She covered her eyes with her hand. "F-for the next two months Adora kept just profusely, *constantly* apologizing to me, even though I assured her it was fine."

"Gee, I wonder why that sounds so familiar." Glimmer snarked.

"She's… *She's such an idiot.*" Despite Catra's best efforts to conceal her eyes, Glimmer could still tell she was crying. "And so am I. *I love her so much*."

"And Adora loves you." Glimmer comforted her. "She has *always* loved you, and regardless of what you've done she has never, at any point, given up on you or stopped loving you. She wants you, more than anything in the entire universe. She **wants** *this*."

"I didn't know." Catra whispered. "All this time, and I, *I-I didn't know."*

"And now you do." Glimmer continued. "Catra, you've owned up to your mistakes and Adora has forgiven you for them. All of the pain you've caused her, it has healed. You cannot change what you've done in the past, you cannot *undo* you having hurt Adora… But the past is in the past, and what matters now is that you make sure you give her the brightest *future* possible. You and Adora both deserve it, **don't mess that up."**

"I won't." Catra promised. "I'm going to go through with this. I'm going to become her wife. I'm going to treat Adora right. And I am *never* going to hurt her again, *ever*."

"Good," Glimmer gently punched Catra's shoulder. "Because Bow and I promised ourselves that we wouldn't *let you*."

Catra backed off from the railing she had sat on this entire time, then turned to Glimmer.

"Thank you, Sparkles." She smiled. "For talking some sense into me."

"That's what friends are for, right? Besides, had to make sure both brides will be there for the wedding!" Glimmer grinned, and the two started walking down the balcony towards the door back to the guest room. When they got to the door, she asked Catra: "Now then, in about 8 hours when you walk down the aisle, what are you going to say to her?"

"'*I do.*'" Catra answered.

"No, *before* that." Glimmer clarified.

At first, Catra was confused. Then she realized what Glimmer meant, and replied with full confidence:

"'*Hey, Adora.*'"

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